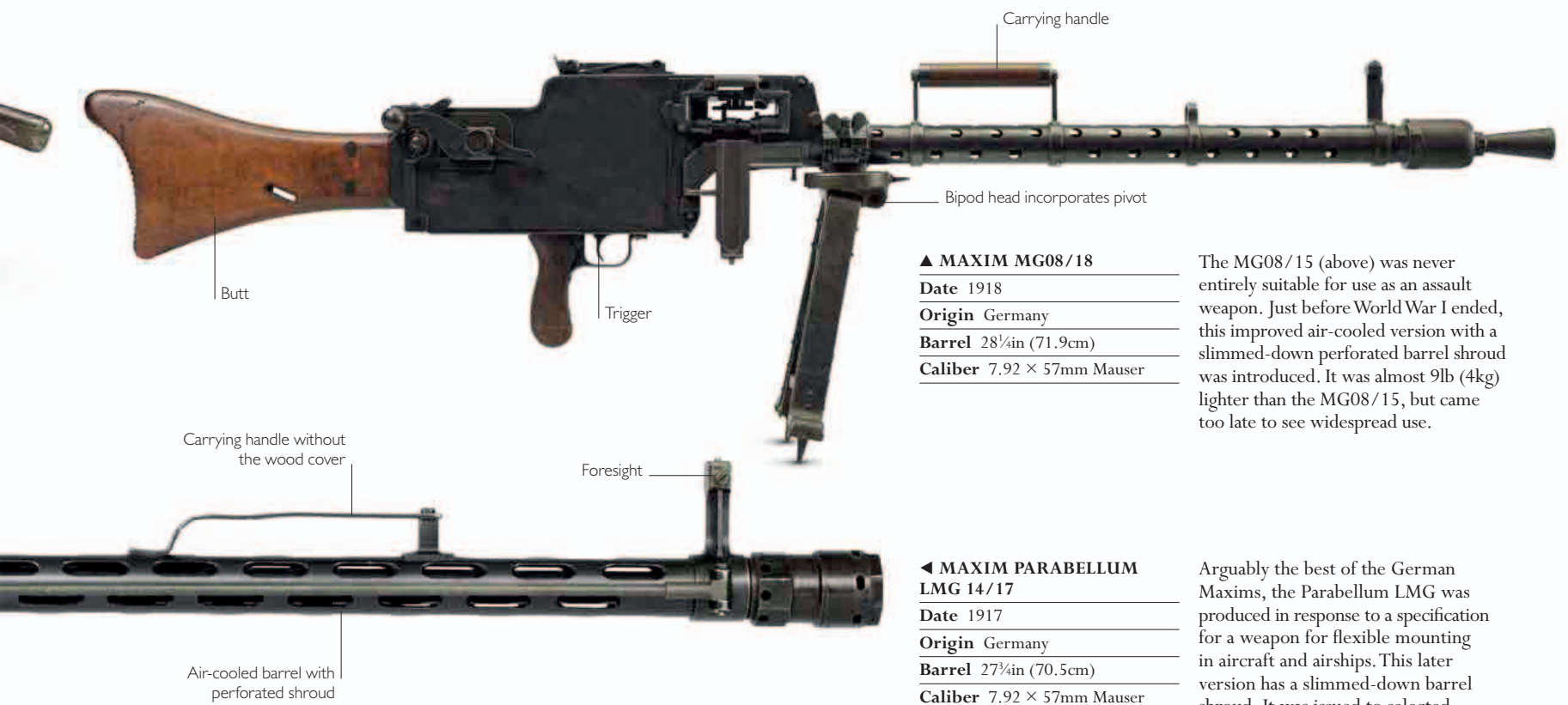




▲ **MAXIM
MASCHINENGEWEHR 08/15**
Date 1917
Origin Germany
Barrel 28¼in (71.9cm)
Caliber 7.92 × 57mm Mauser

Germany's first, hurried attempt to produce a light machine-gun saw the DWM MG08 (see p.196) fitted with a butt, a pistol grip, and a conventional trigger, resulting in the Maxim 08/15. This improved version of the MG08 had a recontoured receiver to reduce the gun's weight and an integral bipod with a shortened ammunition belt contained in a drumlike container. Weighing 30¾lb (14kg), it was still far too heavy. Around 130,000 units were produced, and it became the principal support weapon for the stormtroopers of the *Reichswehr*—Germany's interwar armed forces.



▲ **MAXIM MG08/18**
Date 1918
Origin Germany
Barrel 28¼in (71.9cm)
Caliber 7.92 × 57mm Mauser

The MG08/15 (above) was never entirely suitable for use as an assault weapon. Just before World War I ended, this improved air-cooled version with a slimmed-down perforated barrel shroud was introduced. It was almost 9lb (4kg) lighter than the MG08/15, but came too late to see widespread use.

◀ **MAXIM PARABELLUM
LMG 14/17**
Date 1917
Origin Germany
Barrel 27¾in (70.5cm)
Caliber 7.92 × 57mm Mauser

Arguably the best of the German Maxims, the Parabellum LMG was produced in response to a specification for a weapon for flexible mounting in aircraft and airships. This later version has a slimmed-down barrel shroud. It was issued to selected infantry units in this form toward the end of the war.